

Ernest SONG ♦ Finance Leader & Transformation Officer

Profile

Finance leader with 15+ years leading accounting and transformation mandates for multi-entity, multi-country organisations across BE, FR and NL. I specialise in General Accounting (GL, AP, AR) and financial-close leadership, and in guiding ERP replacements from AS-IS diagnosis to SAP S/4HANA go-live. What sets me apart is perspective: I've sat on both the operator's and the executive-recruiter's side of the table, so I read the numbers and the organisation behind them. I bring calm under pressure, rigorous Power BI / Cognos reporting, and a genuine commitment to turning finance into a lever for growth.

Education

Specialized Master's degree	ESCP Business School , #1 FT 2026 Auditing and Consulting Ranked #1 full-time Master in 2026 (FT Rankings)	Paris, FR 2010 – 2011
Master's degree	Université Paris Nanterre , Management Science and Financial Control Management Science and Financial Control	Paris, FR 2005 – 2010

Competencies

Business

- MS Office (advanced Excel, Power Query)

ERP

- SAP HANA

Business Intelligence

- MS Power BI
- QlikSense
- Business Object
- Cognos
- Hyperion

RPA

- UiPath
- MS PowerAutomate

Agile

- Jira
- Confluence

Data & Analytics

- VBA
- SQL
- R

Languages

Native:

- French
- Khmer
- Teochew

Proficient:

- English

Basics:

- Dutch (A2)
- Spanish
- Mandarin

Interests

Sustainable development

Powerlifting

Mountain biking

Tennis

Interpersonal

Fast-learner

Problem solver

Diplomacy

Driven

Autonomous

Teampayer

Experience

Engie SEM, Strategic Business Analyst & Finance Automation Lead (Freelancer)

Brussels, BE

- Led the financial controlling pilot phase for the SAP S/4HANA migration across French subsidiaries, successfully acting as the core Business Analyst bridging IT architecture and strategic business operations.
- Designed, built, and deployed a robust, automated budget modeling tool from scratch within a critical 2-week timeline, ensuring operational continuity during a resource gap and replacing an unreliable legacy framework.
- Streamlined and automated financial closing processes for commodity trading activities, deploying advanced PowerQuery ETL workflows to safely ingest batches of 1,500+ bookings per close with zero human intervention.
- Reconciled complex financial data structures between middle-office databases (IVDB) and SAP S/4HANA while restructuring and simplifying the Work Breakdown Structure (WWS) project codes to optimize portfolio monitoring.

Jan 2026 – present
9 months

Holcim, Senior Operational Excellence & Data Lead (Freelancer)

Nivelles, BE

- Leveraged data insights derived from market analysis to restructure production workflows post-M&A, significantly enhancing efficiency.
- Managed SAP HANA migration, restructuring data and ensuring system integrity.
- Developed rebate models (matrix & automated SAP), aligning with commercial strategy.
- Implemented QlikSense with new data for financial reporting and insights.
- Ensured data reliability and liaised with auditors on rebate matters.

Jan 2024 – Dec 2025
2 years

Engie Tractebel , Cash Flow & Financial Modeling Specialist (Freelancer) • Design cashflow reporting and cash exposure per project. • Assessment of financing needs in local entity, credit analysis of specific counterpart and impairment testing. • Develop Finance data modelling from SAP for HANA and design Power BI reporting.	Brussels, BE Mar 2023 – Dec 2023 10 months
Shurgard , Investment & Corporate Development Analyst (Freelancer) • Analyzed and managed real estate projects, including construction, redevelopment, and acquisition of self-storage businesses. • Maintained project dashboard and initiated corporate development projects to improve department policies and procedures. • Designed the data model and visualization for the Investment department's Business Intelligence efforts. • Collaborated in the development of a new pricing model using Artificial Intelligence.	Brussels, BE Feb 2022 – Feb 2023 1 year 1 month
Magnetrap , Freelance CFO / Fundraising Consultant • Acted as interim CFO and led fundraising, organizing €3M in debt/equity fund raises. • Created cash flow projections, business plans, and long-term financial goals. • Monitored company performance and implemented corrective actions as needed. • Prepared operating results reports and managed financial models for long-term use.	Mons, BE Nov 2020 – Jan 2022 1 year 3 months
Tobania , Director Business Process Automation • Led development and implementation of citizen developer business model using RPA and self-service BI, including pricing strategy and roadmap. • Managed business development, including marketing strategy, pre-sales, and sales, and identified new business opportunities. • Implemented process optimization, standardization, and harmonization to improve efficiency and profitability for customers. • Provided regular, tailored reports to help customers monitor and control costs and make data-driven business decisions, and established change management structures and strategies to facilitate successful adoption of new processes and technologies.	Brussels, BE Feb 2020 – Oct 2020 9 months
Soap collect , Founder • Established a non-profit organization focused on providing hygiene products to disadvantaged communities. • Formed partnerships with luxury hotel chains to source used soap for reconditioning.	Phnom Penh, KH Jan 2019 – present 7 years 9 months
Degroof Petercam , Performance Management Project Leader • Finance Transformation Operating Model (FTOM) • Designed and implemented a client-centric performance management system. • Optimized finance close process for improved governance, internal control, and data quality. • Led projects related to regulatory reporting sourcing and followed BPM standards. • Conducted gap analysis of business requirements and existing procedures to identify areas for improvement.	Brussels, BE Jan 2018 – Dec 2018 1 year
Vinci Airports , Managing Director & Head of Project Financial Modeling / Cursus Grand Talent • Value creation: valuation at 4 times of acquisition cost. • Led deployment of airport operations at 50+ locations in various countries. • Developed long-term financial business model including analysis of macroeconomic impact, capital expenditures, and concession valuation. • Negotiated extension of concession contract with Portuguese authorities and implemented new financial business model to improve budgeting and forecasting processes. • Managed accounting and financial reporting in accordance with BE-GAAP standards.	Brussels, BE & Lisbon, PT Feb 2016 – Dec 2017 1 year 11 months

Rexel, Freelance Finance Consolidation & Reporting Consultant

Paris, FR

Sept 2014 – Jan 2016
1 year 5 months

- Led the implementation of IFRS financial reporting for Asia-Pacific, Latin America, and Canadian subsidiaries.
- Spearheaded the restructuring process and integration of SAP BPC and Cognos reporting systems.
- Performed annual budgeting, monthly forecasting, and analyses of actual vs. budgeted/estimated results.
- Led the strategic planning process for the organization.

KPMG Audit, Financial Auditor Supervisor

Paris, FR

Jan 2011 – Aug 2014
3 years 8 months

- Conducted audits of financial statements using various accounting standards, including testing of key processes in accordance with SOX requirements.
- Experienced in auditing financial modeling for long-term contracts, particularly in the context of Public-Private Partnerships (PPP).
- Certified FP7 Grant Agreements for the EU Research program and led audit teams and supervised financial auditors.
- Developed partnerships and identified new markets to support business growth.
- Main sector: Construction (Vinci, Eiffage, Colas), Real estate (Nexity), Water distribution (Veolia), International parcels distribution (Geopost from La Poste group), Security (Brink's), Healthcare (DomusVie).

ICM - Brain & Spine Institute, Deputy CFO Trainee

Paris, FR

Nov 2009 – Aug 2010
10 months

- Implemented the budget system and prepared business plans for the scientific teams.
- Established the internal control system for purchasing and donation processes and managed bank reconciliation.
- Prepared the institutional audit necessary for the certification by the 'Comité de la Charte'.